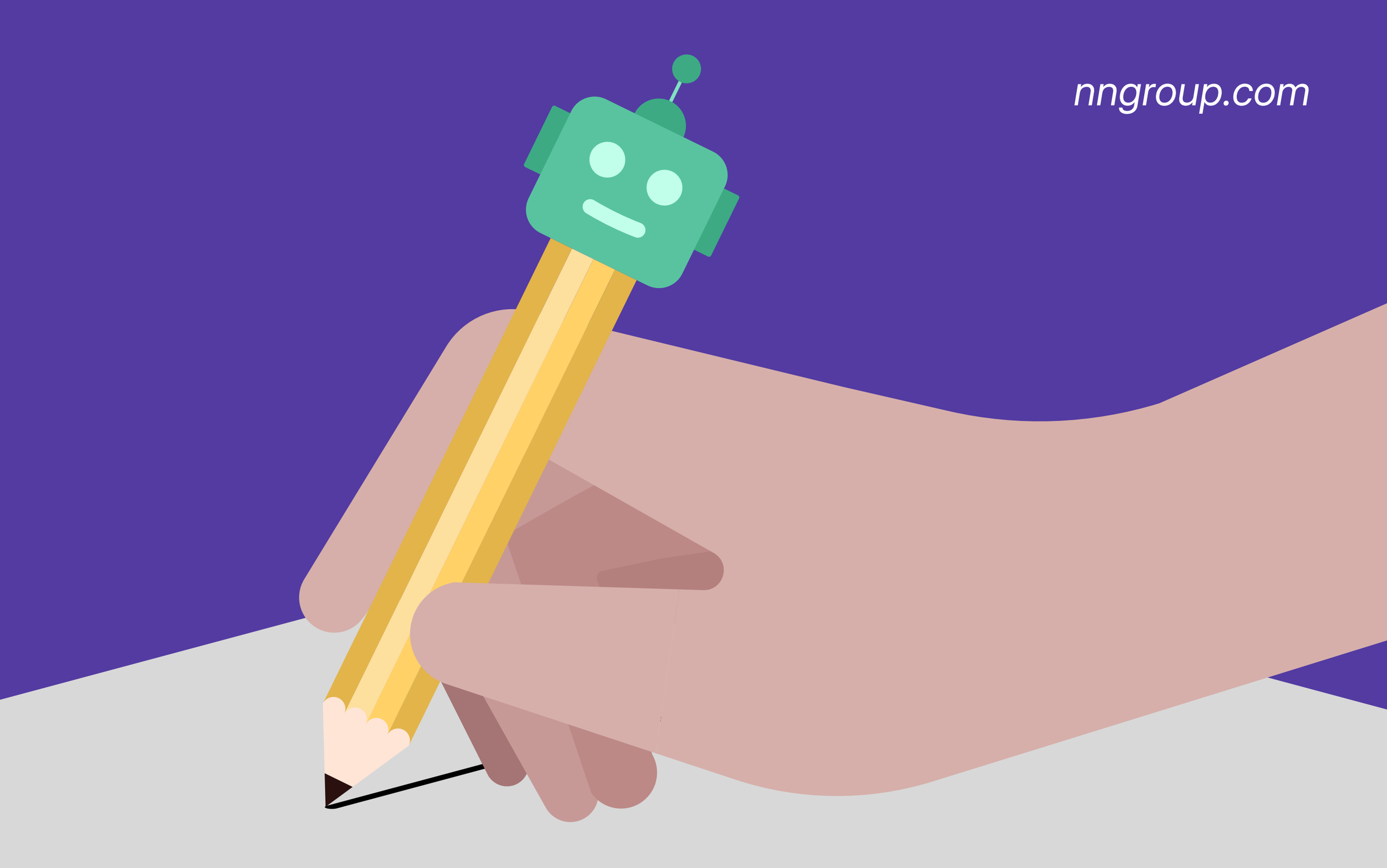

AI Can't Do Research For You

AI-Assisted Research at Every Stage

Kate Moran
Maria Rosala

Article

NN/G

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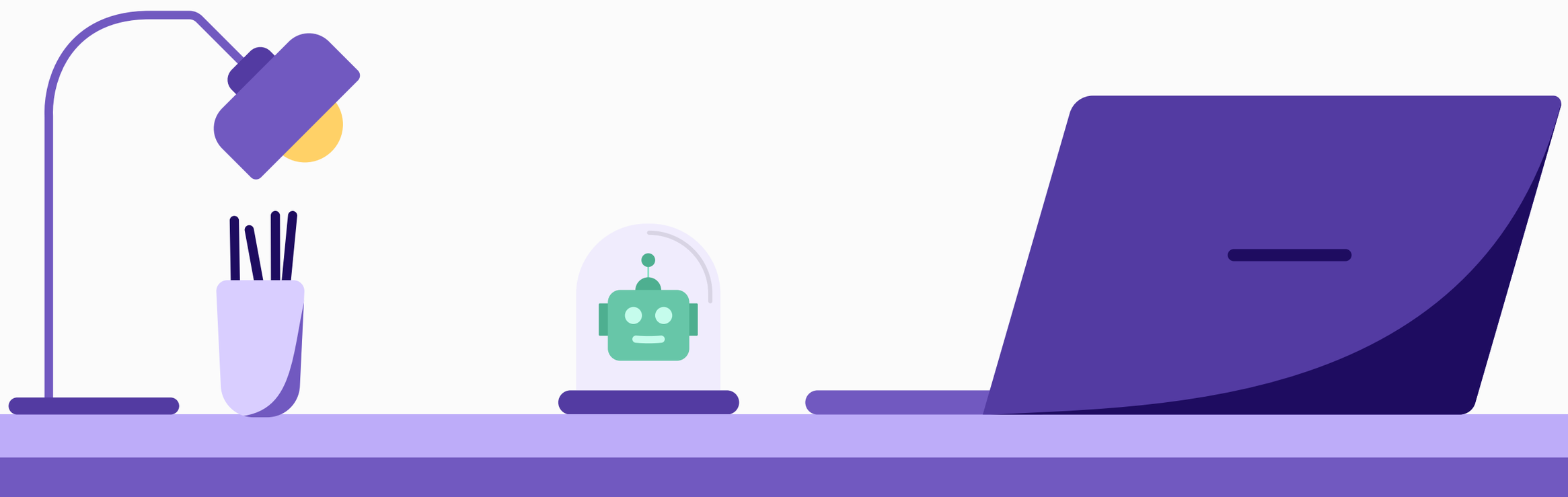
Planning Studies

AI is excellent at desk research, ideation, and documentation. Everything you need to get your study launched.

Tips:

→ Use information-seeking AIs (e.g., Perplexity, ScholarAI).

→ Provide a template when asking AI for research documentation.



Conducting Research

AI has limited research applications.
Use AI to take notes and complete simple interviews.

Tips:

→ Use AI interviews for scalable, structured feedback — not for specialized topics.

→ Avoid AI-moderated usability tests; AI can't see user behavior.

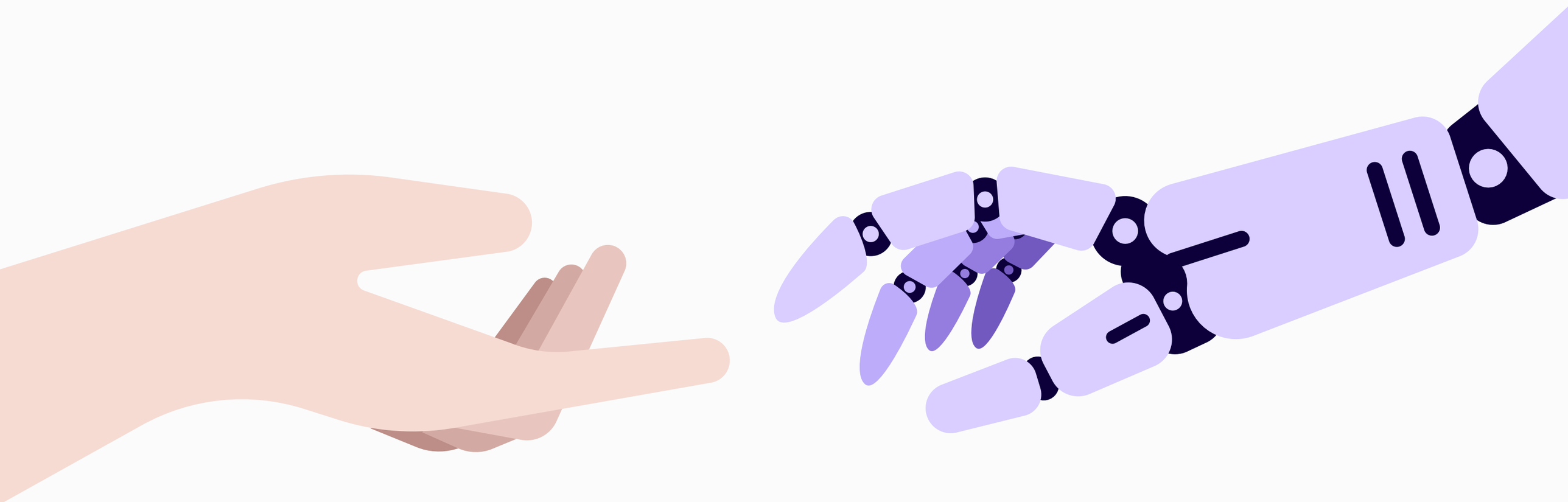
Analyzing Data

AI can help a lot with cleaning and running initial analysis on data. But the **human touch is needed to get deep, meaningful results.**

Tips:

→ AI interviews are best for scale and structure, not specialized feedback.

→ Thoroughly spot-check any AI analysis or data processing.



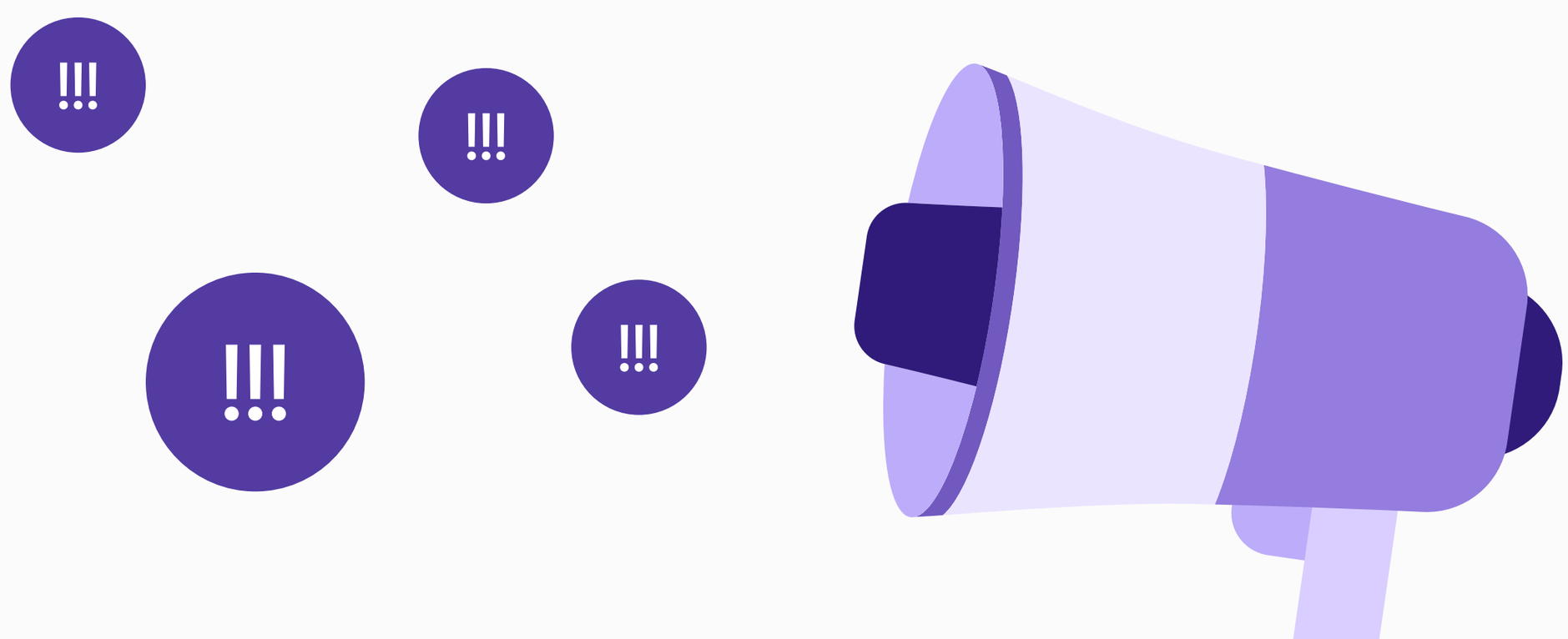
Reporting Research

Time for the world's greatest slide deck! AI makes an excellent #2 when reporting research findings.

Tips:

→ Use AI to proofread and simplify UX jargon, especially for non-UX audiences.

→ Use AI to kick-start deliverables (e.g., personas, journey maps) from research.



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